The Routine I Used to Make My First Million

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 09, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/vQ1xfUcAFsQ Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shares his million-dollar daily routine: wake at 4 a.m., work out twice, grind through deep uninterrupted work before the team arrives, and read during every commute on the F train.

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🌅 Early Morning: Wake-Up & Pre-Workout Stack 0:00

- Wake time: **4 a.m.**
- First action: take pre-workout containing approximately **300 mg of caffeine**

🧘 Meditation 0:00

- Meditates for **10–15 minutes** immediately after the pre-workout
- Serves as a mental warm-up before physical training

🏋️ First Workout of the Day 0:00

- Structure: a **quick weightlifting session** followed by **cardio**
- Showers immediately after and is **out the door by 5 a.m.**
  - He lives in Queens, New York, requiring a commute into the city

🚇 Commute #1: Reading on the F Train 0:00

- Rides the **F train** from Queens to the office

- Uses the entire ride to read — **at least 30 minutes** of reading per commute
  - No detail given on specific books, but reading is treated as non-negotiable commute activity

💼 Deep Work Before Employees Arrive 0:22

- Arrives at the office around **6:00–6:30 a.m.**
- Works **completely uninterrupted** until employees arrive at ~9:00 a.m.
  - This gives roughly **2.5–3 hours of distraction-free deep work** each morning
- Work during this block includes:
  - Checking on **ads** (likely paid digital advertising)
  - **Building websites**
  - **Writing copy**

> The pre-employee window — 6 a.m. to 9 a.m. of uninterrupted output — appears to be the core engine of his million-dollar productivity.

👥 Managing the Team 0:22

- Employees arrive around **9:00 a.m.**
- Brandon shifts from solo deep work to **managing and overseeing** their work
- This management phase runs until **6:00–7:00 p.m.**
  - Roughly an **8–10 hour** management and execution stretch

🏋️ Second Workout & Evening Wind-Down 0:44

- After the workday ends, he works out again: **30 minutes to 1 hour**
- No details given on the type of training for the second session

🚇 Commute #2 & Sleep 0:44

- Gets back on the **F train** and reads the **entire ride home**
- Arrives home and goes **straight to sleep**
  - No mention of nighttime entertainment, social media, or leisure — sleep is the immediate end of the day
- The full cycle then repeats starting at **4 a.m.**